

Export: resolving and transferring layouts

Technical Support FAQ

Category: General Basis Functions->Interface

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Question:

How can I only export the layout contents to AutoCAD?

Answer:

You can export a complete layout including its drawing files and layers from Allplan's layout editor. AutoCAD provides the model space (for the design) and the paper space (for the plan layout). There are several ways of exporting layouts from Allplan to AutoCAD. For example, the layouts can be resolved before they are transferred. The **"resolve and transfer layouts"** export option produces as identical a layout as possible in AutoCAD or any other CAD system. A layout created in this way is suitable for architecture competitions or a planning partner can use it as a backdrop for further editing. What you create in AutoCAD is the model space.

Export:

- Select **File -> Export-> Export AutoCAD Data...** Select the layout you want to export and click **OK** to confirm.
- A dialog box opens. In the *Save in area* at the top, select the folder where you want to save the exported file and select the required *file type*.
- Click **Options...** and define the required options on the *General Setting* tab. In Allplan 2009 and later, you can select the exchange favorite 1 (Allplan's layer structure is transferred) or 2 (Allplan's layout and drawing file structure is transferred as a layer structure) or you can set the options manually.
- If necessary, define additional settings in the options and confirm by clicking **OK**.
- Then start the export by clicking **Save**.
- After the conversion the **Export:...** dialog box appears. Using **Modify**, you can still change the configuration. When finished, click **OK**. The file is created.

Result in AutoCAD:

1. File(s) created:

A single file (DWG or DXF) is created.

2. Resolving elements:

Elements in drawing files are exploded into single lines (for example, hatching, patterns, dimension lines turn into lines and text).

Elements created directly in the layout are transferred as complex elements or they are resolved, depending on the settings in the 'Explode elements' area.

3. Clipping boundaries:

A clipping boundary is an area that is cut, for example, by a layout window. Clipping boundaries are taken into account. The layout sheet can also act as a clipping boundary. When exporting data using the **Currently visible data** transfer mode, you therefore need to make sure that all the elements are within the layout sheet.

4. Allplan structure:

In the Options... -> *Allplan specific* tab, *Arrange layers* area, you can transfer the following structures:

Layers only: only the layers of the drawing files are transferred; the drawing file structure is lost. This is useful when a drawing file with layers was placed in the layout.

Documents only: only the drawing file structure is transferred; layers in drawing files are lost. This is useful for users who only work with drawing files.

Documents and layers: this setting also transfers Allplan's layer structure. Each layer is given a prefix referring to the associated drawing file.

For example: there are two drawing files: DF1 and DF2 with the Wall layer. In AutoCAD, for example, the layer names are DF_1#Wall and DF_2#Wall.

5. Paper space – model space:

Note: the data volume can increase significantly as elements like hatching, patterns and dimension lines are exploded. Here, the focus is on the transfer of graphics. Using this export option, you create data in AutoCAD's model space, which corresponds to the contents of the drawing files in Allplan. The paper space (layout) is equivalent to Allplan's layout editor. The layout border and the drawing files are placed as a group on one layer each in AutoCAD and can be exploded there.

To prevent the program from creating groups, you need to select the following setting before you start the conversion: open the **Options, Advanced Setting** tab, **Explode compounds** area and select the **Composite elements** check box.

6. Resizing factor:

If you want to transfer the layout so that it is created at the standard AutoCAD scale of 1:1 in the DWG file, you need to specify the corresponding resizing factor when you export the data. To do this, open the *Options, General Setting* tab and go to the *Coordinates and length parameters* area (using meters and a scale of 1:50, the resizing factor is 50, for example).

Note:

You can also select multiple layouts and export them in one go.

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